

CIMA AI User Guide

Your Intelligent Legal Assistant for Modern Law Practice

Welcome to CIMA AI

CIMA AI is your complete digital workspace designed specifically for legal professionals. Think of it as having an expert assistant that helps you research cases, review contracts, draft documents, and manage your matters—all in one secure platform.

This guide will help you understand what CIMA AI can do for you and how to use it effectively in your daily legal practice.

What is CIMA AI?

CIMA AI is a specialized platform that combines the power of artificial intelligence with legal expertise to help lawyers, arbitrators, and legal professionals work more efficiently. Whether you're handling international arbitration, reviewing complex contracts, or researching case law, CIMA AI provides intelligent support every step of the way.

What makes CIMA AI different?

- Designed specifically for African and international legal practice
 - Understands arbitration, commercial law, and regional jurisdictions
 - Provides instant access to legal authorities, cases, and rules
 - Helps you draft, review, and analyze documents with confidence
 - Keeps all your matters organized in one place
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Getting Started

Creating Your Account

When you first access CIMA AI, you'll create your personal account:

1. Enter your email address and create a secure password
2. Provide your full name and select your role (Lawyer, Arbitrator, Paralegal, etc.)
3. Choose your primary jurisdiction (Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, International, etc.)
4. Add your organization name if applicable

Once registered, you'll land on your **Dashboard**—your command center for all legal work.

Your Dashboard Overview

The Dashboard is designed to give you a complete view of your practice at a glance:

Quick Statistics

- Number of active cases you're handling
- Total documents stored in your workspace
- Research sessions conducted
- Upcoming hearings and deadlines

Quick Actions Four buttons let you jump straight into common tasks:

- **New Research:** Start searching for legal authorities
- **New Case:** Open a new matter
- **Upload Document:** Add contracts or legal files
- **Ask AI:** Get instant legal guidance

Recent Activity See your most recent cases and documents so you can pick up right where you left off.

Upcoming Hearings A calendar view shows your next scheduled court dates or arbitration hearings with countdown timers.

Core Features Explained

1. Legal Research

What it does: Searches across thousands of legal authorities including case law, statutes, arbitration rules, and international treaties to find relevant precedents and legal principles.

How to use it:

1. Ask Your Question in Plain Language

- Type your legal question naturally: "What are the grounds for challenging an arbitrator under ICC Rules?"
- Use the microphone icon to dictate your question instead of typing
- Click "Sharpen Query" to let AI refine your question for better results

2. Filter Your Results

- Choose your jurisdiction (Ghana, International, England & Wales, etc.)
- Select source types (Statutes, Case Law, Rules, Treaties)
- Results show relevance scores so you know which sources matter most

3. Review Your Results

- Each source shows its citation, jurisdiction, and an excerpt
- Click "Read More" to see the full text
- AI provides a synthesis that explains how the sources relate to your question

4. Validate Authority

- Use the "Check Authority Status" button to verify if a case is still good law
- See if cases have been followed, distinguished, or overruled
- Get confidence scores for reliability

5. Save and Export

- Copy results as rich text for your documents
- All research is automatically saved to your history
- Link research to specific cases for easy reference later

Best for: Finding legal precedents, understanding new legal concepts, preparing legal arguments, checking if cases are still valid.

2. Cases & Matters Management

What it does: Organizes all your legal matters—whether arbitration, litigation, or mediation—in one structured workspace where you can track deadlines, parties, documents, and progress.

How to use it:

1. Create a New Case

- Click "New Case" and enter basic details:
 - Case title (e.g., "ABC Corp v. XYZ Ltd - Construction Dispute")
 - Matter number (your internal reference)
 - Type (Arbitration, Litigation, or Mediation)
 - Framework (ICC, UNCITRAL, LCIA, or Court-based)
- Add parties with their roles (Claimant, Respondent, Arbitrator, etc.)
- Write a brief description of the dispute

2. Work Within Your Case

Once created, your case workspace has organized sections:

- **Overview:** See all case details at a glance
- **Issues:** Track the legal and factual issues in dispute
- **Deadlines:** Add submission deadlines, hearing dates, and other time-sensitive tasks
- **Hearings:** Schedule preliminary meetings, substantive hearings, and award dates
- **Evidence:** Organize documents, witness statements, and exhibits
- **Documents:** Link relevant contracts, briefs, and correspondence

3. Track Urgency

- Color-coded status badges (Active, Pending, Closed, Settled)
- Countdown timers for next hearings
- Overdue deadline alerts in red

4. Search and Filter

- Use the search bar to find cases by name or matter number
- Filter by status to focus on active matters only
- Sort by recent activity or upcoming deadlines

Best for: Managing multiple matters, tracking deadlines, organizing case documents, preparing for hearings, maintaining a complete case file.

3. Contract Review

What it does: Automatically analyzes contracts to identify risks, problematic clauses, missing provisions, and obligations—then suggests improvements.

How to use it:

1. Upload Your Contract

- Drag and drop a PDF or Word document, or paste text directly
- System accepts contracts in various formats

2. Configure the Review

- Select document type (Commercial Contract, Employment Agreement, Lease, Arbitration Agreement, etc.)
- Choose jurisdiction for compliance checking
- Optionally link to an active case
- Attach a "playbook" (your client's standards or preferences)

3. Wait for Analysis (usually 30-60 seconds) The system automatically:

- Extracts and reads all clauses
- Scores overall risk (0-100 scale)
- Identifies problematic provisions
- Checks for missing standard clauses
- Extracts obligations for each party

4. Review the Results Navigate through organized tabs:

Overview Tab

- Risk gauge with color coding (green = low risk, red = high risk)
- AI summary of the contract's purpose and key terms
- Detected parties and governing law

Clauses Tab

- Every clause listed with risk assessment
- Risk badges: Critical (red), High (orange), Medium (yellow), Low (green)
- Click any clause to see:
 - What makes it risky
 - Suggested improvements
 - Market-standard alternatives
- AI actions on each clause: Explain, Simplify, Rewrite, Make Mutual, Reduce Risk

Obligations Tab

- Side-by-side comparison of what each party must do
- Clear breakdown of responsibilities

Missing Clauses Tab

- Standard clauses not found in the contract
- Why each clause is important
- Option to generate suggested language

Redlines Tab

- Visual markup showing proposed changes
- Compare original vs. suggested version
- Export marked-up contract

Arbitration Tab (if applicable)

- Specific analysis of arbitration clauses
- Checks for enforceability
- Identifies seat, institution, and governing rules
- Suggests improvements

AI Insights Tab

- Strategic takeaways
- Negotiation points
- Commercial considerations

Q&A Tab

- Ask follow-up questions about the contract
- Get instant AI answers with citations

5. Take Action

- Export full analysis to Word or PDF
- Save analysis for future reference
- Use insights to negotiate better terms

Best for: Due diligence, contract negotiations, risk assessment, client advisory, identifying unfavorable terms before signing.

4. Drafting Studio

What it does: Helps you create legal documents from scratch or templates, with AI assistance to strengthen arguments, add citations, and ensure professional quality.

How to use it:

Option A: Natural Language Drafting

1. Describe what you want to draft in plain language:
 - "Draft a Notice of Arbitration for a \$5 million construction dispute under ICC Rules"
 - "Create a non-disclosure agreement for a joint venture in Ghana"
2. Select jurisdiction and link to a case if relevant
3. Click "Generate Draft"

4. AI produces a complete first draft

Option B: Template-Based Drafting

1. Browse templates by category:
 - Arbitration (Notices, Statements of Claim, Awards)
 - Contracts (NDAs, Service Agreements, Joint Ventures)
 - Litigation (Pleadings, Motions, Briefs)
 - Corporate (Resolutions, Agreements)
2. Select your template
3. Fill in the blanks (party names, dates, amounts, etc.)
4. Add any special instructions
5. Generate document

Editing and Enhancement

Once your draft is generated, use the powerful editing tools:

Left Panel - Your Document

- Rich text editor with formatting options
- Three view modes:
 - **Full**: Complete formal document
 - **Short Form**: Condensed version
 - **Plain English**: Simple summary for non-lawyers
- Word count tracker
- Version history (undo/redo changes)

Right Panel - AI Tools

AI Assistant Section

- Ask for custom changes: "Make this section more persuasive"
- Get suggestions for improvement
- Request additional clauses or sections

AI Actions on Selected Text Select any paragraph and choose:

- **Rewrite**: Make clearer and more professional
- **Strengthen Argument**: Add more persuasive language
- **Add Citations**: Insert relevant legal authorities
- **Simplify**: Make more accessible
- **Make Neutral**: Use balanced tone (for arbitrators)
- **Formalize**: Add legal language

Document Review

- Quick risk check on your draft
- Identifies ambiguities or unclear provisions
- Suggests missing sections

Research Panel

- Search for legal authorities without leaving the page
- Insert citations directly into your draft

Clause Library

- Browse standard clauses by category
- Insert with one click
- See variations and alternatives

Keyboard Shortcuts

- Press Ctrl+K (or Cmd+K) for Command Bar—type what you want AI to do

Saving and Exporting

- Click "Save Draft" to store in your workspace
- Export to Word or PDF for final delivery
- All versions are automatically saved

Best for: Creating arbitration documents, drafting contracts, preparing legal opinions, writing demand letters, generating awards and orders.

5. AI Assistant (Chat)

What it does: Provides a conversational interface where you can ask any legal question, upload documents for analysis, discuss case strategy, and get instant guidance across 10 specialized legal contexts.

How to use it:

1. Choose Your Context Select the area that matches your need:

- **General Legal:** Broad legal questions and advice
- **Legal Research:** Finding cases and statutes
- **Drafting:** Writing legal documents
- **Document Analysis:** Understanding uploaded files
- **Contract Review:** Quick contract questions
- **Arbitration:** International arbitration guidance
- **Case Strategy:** Strategic advice for your matters
- **Settlement:** Negotiation and settlement tactics
- **Evidence:** Evidence analysis and admissibility
- **Award Drafting:** Writing arbitral awards

2. Start a Conversation

- Click "New Conversation" to begin
- Type your question or use voice input
- Use "Sharpen" to improve your question
- Get starter prompts if you're not sure what to ask

3. **Attach Context** Help AI understand your situation better:

- Upload a document (PDF, Word, or text file)
- Link to an active case from your workspace
- Reference a document you've already uploaded
- Tag specific legal authorities with @ mentions

4. **Receive Answers**

- AI streams the response in real-time
- Answers include citations to legal sources
- Click source links to read the full authority
- Copy answers as formatted text or plain text

5. **Continue the Conversation**

- Ask follow-up questions
- Request clarification
- Ask AI to rephrase or expand on points
- All context from previous messages is remembered

6. **Manage Conversations**

- Your conversation history appears in the left sidebar
- Click any past conversation to continue it
- Delete old conversations you no longer need
- Each context keeps its own conversation list

Example Questions:

- "What are the requirements for a valid arbitration agreement under Ghanaian law?"
- "Review this employment contract and tell me if the termination clause is reasonable"
- "What's the best strategy for challenging an arbitrator's impartiality?"
- "Draft talking points for a settlement negotiation in a construction dispute"

Best for: Quick legal questions, document understanding, case strategy brainstorming, getting second opinions, learning new legal concepts.

6. Documents Management

What it does: Centralizes all your legal files in one organized library where you can upload, search, summarize, and link documents to cases.

How to use it:

1. **Upload Documents**

- Click "Upload Document" or drag files onto the page
- Accepts PDF, Word, and text files
- System automatically extracts text content

2. Organize Your Files

- Create folders for different matters or clients
- Move documents between folders
- Tag documents by type (Contract, Brief, Award, Evidence, Statute)

3. Review Document Details

- Each document shows:
 - File name and type
 - Upload date
 - Linked case (if any)
 - AI-generated summary
 - Risk score (for contracts)
 - Word/page count

4. Search and Filter

- Search by document name or content
- Filter by document type
- Sort by date or relevance

5. Use Documents Elsewhere

- Link documents to cases
- Attach to AI Assistant conversations
- Reference in Contract Review
- Cite in drafting

Best for: Document storage, organizing case files, quick access to contracts and briefs, keeping everything in one place.

7. Legal Library

What it does: Provides instant access to a curated collection of legal authorities including arbitration statutes, institutional rules, case law, and treaties.

How to use it:

1. Browse by Category

- **Arbitration Statutes:** Ghana ADR Act 2010, UNCITRAL Model Law, New York Convention
- **Institutional Rules:** ICC Rules, UNCITRAL Rules, LCIA Rules, AFSA Rules
- **Practice Areas:** Commercial Arbitration, Investment Arbitration, Enforcement
- **Case Law:** Key precedents from multiple jurisdictions

2. Search the Library

- Use the search bar to find specific authorities
- Results show document title, type, and jurisdiction
- Click to open full text

3. Read Documents

- Full text of statutes, rules, and cases
- For case law, see:
 - Facts of the case
 - Legal issues
 - Court's holding
 - Key principles
 - Citations to this case

4. Use in Your Work

- Copy citations for your documents
- Reference in research and drafting
- Tag with @ mentions in AI Assistant
- Extract specific provisions

Best for: Accessing arbitration rules quickly, reading key cases, finding statutory provisions, building legal arguments with authority.

Understanding Key Concepts

Risk Scores

When analyzing contracts, CIMA AI assigns a risk score from 0-100:

- **0-30 (Green):** Low risk - well-balanced contract
- **31-60 (Yellow):** Medium risk - some concerns to address
- **61-85 (Orange):** High risk - significant issues present
- **86-100 (Red):** Critical risk - major problems requiring immediate attention

Citations and Sources

Whenever AI provides information, it includes citations to legal authorities. Click these to verify the information and read the source yourself. This ensures you can trust the guidance and use it professionally.

Authority Validation

The "Check Authority Status" feature tells you if a case is still "good law":

- **Followed:** Other courts have applied the same reasoning (strong authority)
- **Distinguished:** Courts have limited its application (use carefully)
- **Disapproved:** Courts have disagreed with it (weak authority)
- **Overruled:** No longer valid (do not use)

Jurisdictions

CIMA AI specializes in:

- **African Jurisdictions:** Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, South Africa

- **International Arbitration:** ICC, UNCITRAL, LCIA, AFSA
- **Other Systems:** England & Wales, New York Convention countries

Always select the correct jurisdiction for accurate results.

Common Workflows

Workflow 1: Reviewing a New Client Contract

1. Go to **Contract Review**
2. Upload the contract
3. Select document type and jurisdiction
4. Review the risk score and AI summary
5. Check the **Clauses** tab for problems
6. Review **Missing Clauses** section
7. Export the analysis with redlines
8. Share findings with your client

Workflow 2: Preparing an Arbitration Notice

1. Go to **Cases** and create a new matter
2. Add parties, dispute details, and select ICC (or other framework)
3. Go to **Drafting Studio**
4. Select "Notice of Arbitration" template
5. Link to your new case
6. Fill in the variables (amounts, dates, claims)
7. Use AI actions to strengthen your statement of claim
8. Export to Word for filing

Workflow 3: Researching a Legal Issue

1. Go to **Legal Research**
2. Type your question (e.g., "Can arbitrators award punitive damages?")
3. Select relevant jurisdictions (Ghana + International)
4. Review retrieved sources and AI analysis
5. Validate key cases with Citator
6. Copy findings for your memo
7. Link research to the relevant case

Workflow 4: Preparing for a Hearing

1. Open your case in **Cases**
2. Check the **Hearings** tab for upcoming dates
3. Review linked **Evidence** and **Documents**
4. Go to **AI Assistant** (Context: Case Strategy)
5. Attach your case and key documents
6. Ask: "What are the strongest arguments for our position on [issue]?"
7. Use insights to prepare your oral submissions

8. Draft hearing notes in **Drafting Studio**

Tips for Getting the Best Results

Be Specific

Instead of "contract law in Ghana," ask "what are the requirements for a valid consideration under the Contracts Act 1960?"

Use Context

When asking questions in AI Assistant, attach relevant documents or link to cases so AI has full context.

Review AI Suggestions

AI is a powerful assistant, but always review its output with your professional judgment. Think of it as a first draft that you refine.

Tag Authorities

Use @ mentions to reference specific cases or statutes. This helps AI provide more targeted analysis.

Save Your Work

Use the save feature frequently in Drafting Studio and link documents to cases so nothing gets lost.

Check Citations

Always verify that cited cases and statutes are correct by clicking through to read the source.

Explore Templates

Don't start from scratch—browse templates in Drafting Studio to save time.

Data Security and Professional Standards

Your Data is Private

- All your cases, documents, and research are stored securely
- Only you can access your workspace
- CIMA AI uses industry-standard encryption

Professional Use

- CIMA AI is a professional tool designed to assist lawyers
- It does not replace your legal judgment
- Always review AI-generated content before using it with clients
- Verify all legal citations independently

Important Notice CIMA AI provides information and assistance but does not constitute legal advice. You remain responsible for all work product and professional obligations. Use CIMA AI as a research and drafting assistant, not as a substitute for your expertise.

Getting Help

In-App Guidance

- Look for the  icon throughout the platform for contextual tips
- Hover over buttons to see what they do
- Use the tutorial on the Dashboard if you're new

Technical Support

If you encounter any issues:

- Check your internet connection
- Refresh the page
- Log out and log back in
- Contact support through the profile menu

Best Practices

- Keep your browser updated
 - Use Chrome, Firefox, or Edge for best performance
 - Clear your browser cache if pages load slowly
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Quick Reference

Keyboard Shortcuts (Drafting Studio)

- **Ctrl+K / Cmd+K:** Open command bar
- **Ctrl+S / Cmd+S:** Save draft
- **Ctrl+Z / Cmd+Z:** Undo
- **Ctrl+Y / Cmd+Y:** Redo

Status Colors

-  **Green:** Low risk / Active
-  **Yellow:** Medium risk / Pending
-  **Orange:** High risk
-  **Red:** Critical risk / Overdue
-  **Blue:** Settled / Completed

Document Types Supported

- PDF (with text extraction and OCR)
- Microsoft Word (.docx)

- Plain text (.txt)
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Welcome to More Efficient Legal Practice

CIMA AI is designed to handle the time-consuming parts of legal work—research, document review, drafting—so you can focus on strategy, client relationships, and advocacy.

Start with simple tasks like searching for a case or uploading a contract to review. As you become more comfortable, explore advanced features like linking research to cases, using AI actions in drafting, and building a comprehensive legal library.

Remember: CIMA AI is your assistant, not a replacement for your expertise. Use it to work smarter, faster, and with greater confidence.

Ready to begin?

Log in to your Dashboard and explore. Every feature is designed to make your legal practice more efficient and effective.

CIMA AI - Intelligent Legal Technology for Modern Law Firms